

2025 Budget Hearings September 6th Segment #1

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZbBH0gUesHQ
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Municipal Budget Work Session Report

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting back from recess [00:00:30](#) to continue municipal budget work sessions.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Webb, Mr. Plin, Mr. M., Mr. Hughes, Mr. G., and Piper.
 - **Members Absent:** (Not explicitly specified in roll call excerpt)
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in the opening roll call.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** None.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

(Note: This meeting primarily consisted of departmental budget review sessions and line-item adjustments for the upcoming fiscal year. No formal final ordinances or statutory roll-call votes

on budget adoptions were executed during this portion of the transcript.)

Departmental Budget Reviews & Adjustments

- **00:01:51 Board of Commissioners Budget**
 - **Presenter:** Staff / Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed line-item accounts including part-time staff pay adjustments (flat \$15.60), pre-employment reimbursement, unemployment, office supplies, operating supplies, operating fuel, Brave Flags, contractual services (Justice Center agreements, county ability agreements, yoc), Meridian Services, postage, transportation, communications (cell phones), legal, official bonds, liability insurance, work comp, utilities, mowing/maintenance, vehicle maintenance, and equipment/machinery. Adjusted elected officials' salaries based on a proposed 4% increase.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Discussion only; adjustments noted for compilation by staff.
- **00:24:23 Surveyor's Office Budget**
 - **Presenter:** Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Noted that adjustments were primarily within the salary line and perpetuation funds. No major issues raised.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed by consensus.
- **00:25:16 Purdue Extension Budget**
 - **Presenter:** Justin
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed salaries and contractual services, noting limited discretionary funds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed by consensus.
- **00:26:13 Coroner's Office Budget**
 - **Presenter:** Gavin Green (Delaware County Coroner)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Explained line-item reorganization combining old numbers into detailed breakouts. Discussed vehicle lights as a one-time expense, mobile CAD licenses, email licenses in the cloud, laptop replacement life cycles, hotspots, body bag distribution to local ambulance services and fire departments (approx. 120 bags distributed last year as part of operational partnerships), and an increase in part-time per-case fees (\$25 to \$50 and \$12.25 increases) due to the loss of a weekend coverage person.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed by consensus.
- **00:35:30 Judicial Branch / Court Security Presentation**
 - **Presenter:** Judge Doug Mayward (Circuit Court 3)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed the council regarding court security, specifically advocating for a fortified, secure bench and security enhancements for the juvenile courtroom. Cited historical and modern examples of courtroom violence against

judges to emphasize that security risks are real and emotional volatility is high in juvenile and family law proceedings.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presented for council consideration during budget review.
- **00:41:09 County Assessor Budget**
 - **Presenter:** Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed longevity pay integration, salary line adjustments, postage for mandatory notices (33,000 notices), and assessment software/costs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed and noted for adjustments.
- **00:49:06 Prosecutor's Office Budget**
 - **Presenter:** Prosecutor / Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed general fund lines, transcription fees, professional services (trial witness interviews, suspect transcriptions), witness fees, and health insurance line item allocations. Discussed deputy prosecutor staffing levels and potential seniority-based salary schedules.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed by consensus.
- **01:08:21 Courts / Jury Chairs & Technology**
 - **Presenter:** Court / Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed the purchase of durable medical-grade jury chairs for courtrooms (\$330 per chair, 14 chairs per courtroom across 5 courts) to replace cloth chairs due to wear and sanitation issues involving detainees. Debated purchasing all at once versus phasing the replacement over multiple years (decided to adjust to purchase for 3 courts initially). Also reviewed software, computer replacements, and Title IV-D funding.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adjusted line items for phased purchasing by voice consensus.
- **01:26:37 Adult Probation & User Fees**
 - **Presenter:** Staff / Court Representatives
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed user fee funds, diversion programs, employee health insurance line tracking, and nonreverting fund balances.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed by consensus.
- **01:48:08 Public Defender Office Budget**
 - **Presenter:** Public Defender Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed proposed public defender salary adjustments based on state study medians, state public defender commission reimbursement (40%), case load limitations, professional services (psychological testing, medical investigations, interpreters), and supplemental fund restrictions. Authorized reducing public defender salary requests to \$55,000 per attorney as a working number.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adjusted working numbers by consensus.

- **02:32:17 Plan Commission / Building Commissioner Budget**
 - **Presenter:** Kyle / Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed transitioning a part-time secretary/office assistant position to full-time to handle high permit volumes (over 930 permits this year) and contractor registrations. Reviewed job titles, administrative responsibilities, professional service contracts for attorney fees, and fuel operating supplies.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed and adjusted by consensus.
- **02:56:35 Emergency Management Agency (EMA) Budget**
 - **Presenter:** Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed salaries, deputy director leveling, overtime reductions, and grant funding reimbursements (\$65,000 lump sum salary reimbursement).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adjusted line items by voice consensus.
- **03:06:45 County-Wide Utilities & Facilities Review**
 - **Presenter:** Staff / Council Members
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Examined significant year-over-year increases in utility budgets (raising concerns over a ~\$250,000 jump). Requested historical utility cost analyses for the Justice Center and county buildings over a 5-year period.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information requested; item held for further data.
- **03:11:47 EMS Budget**
 - **Presenter:** EMS Director
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed medic and EMT salary structures, overtime projections, educational incentive pay policy adherence, billing service contractual percentages (5.4%), and projected Medicare revenue reimbursements (~\$43,000).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed by consensus.
- **03:42:21 Auditor's Office & Grant Administration Discussion**
 - **Presenter:** Auditor / Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reduced Baker Tilly contractual service line items by \$25,000. Discussed unspent opioid settlement grant funds (\$1.3 million received to date, another \$1.7 million expected) and the lack of an established plan or grant administrator to disburse and maintain compliance on these funds. Debated the creation of a grant writer/administrator position.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed by consensus; adjustments noted.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No general citizen public comment period was conducted during this budgetary work session.*
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** 04:03:54 The board agreed to break for lunch and reconvene at 1:40 PM to continue salary discussions and finalize departmental budget targets ahead of a target completion time of 4:00 PM.
- **Adjournment:** 04:04:12 The meeting recessed for lunch at 12:35 PM with instructions to return at 1:40 PM.

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